MASKINHALLEN · USER MANUAL · VERSION 4.0

SMIDET

EUCLIDEAN FORGE · 26 ENGINES · RIFFS FROM RHYTHM

Four smiths hammer skewed euclidean patterns. Rhythm turns into riffs, basslines, dub stabs and drum grooves, and it always lands on the one.



VST3 · AU · LV2 · STANDALONE
MACOS · WINDOWS · LINUX

MASKINHALLEN

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01 WELCOME

Four smiths hammer skewed euclidean patterns. Every hit plays the next note in the smith's note loop, so rhythm turns into hypnotic riffs, basslines, dub stabs and whole drum grooves. The rings drift apart, but everything lands on **ETTAN** (the one).

SMIDET 4 is a full synth. Each smith picks a **material**: 26 sound engines, from modal metal (steel, cast iron, sheet metal) to synthesised kick, hat and clap, acid, FM, strings, rave saws, voices, granular clouds, samples and your own sound folders. Nothing is a static sample loop: every hit sounds a little different depending on where and how hard the hammer strikes.

- **Four smiths**, each a euclidean ring with its own material, hammer, note loop and character.
- **26 materials**, including a built-in drum forge and your own sample folders.
- **The forge**: scale, key, chord, ETTAN, DÉJÀ VU, CHAOS and more.
- **302 presets** in 22 categories, from KICK and ACID to TUNG INDUSTRI.
- **DRAG MIDI**: drag the rings' patterns straight into your DAW.

SWEDISH LABELS

`Smed`	Smith	`Material / Hammare`	Material / Hammer
`Steg / Slag / Vrid`	Steps / Hits / Rotate	`Toner / Omfång`	Notes / Range
`Klang / Ljus`	Ring / Brightness	`Studs / Glid`	Bounce / Glide
`Lag / Takt`	Team / Rate	`Ettan`	The one (reset)
`Glöd / Eko / Rum`	Glow / Echo / Room	`Rost / Härdning`	Rust / Quench
`Driv / Punch / Buss`	Drive / Punch / Bus	`Eget / Stämd`	Own sound / Tuned

THE WINDOW



02 INSTALL

Unzip the file for your system. You get a folder called **SMIDET**. Then run the installer for your system and restart your DAW (or rescan plug-ins). SMIDET shows up as an instrument.

MACOS

1. Double-click `SMIDET-macOS.zip` in Downloads.
2. Open Terminal and run:
   `bash ~/Downloads/SMIDET/installera.command`
3. Quit your DAW completely and start it again.

VST3, AU and a standalone app. macOS 11 or newer, Intel or Apple Silicon. The installer copies the plug-ins and removes macOS's block on downloaded plug-ins.

WINDOWS

1. Right-click `SMIDET-Windows.zip` and choose **Extract all**.
2. Open the `SMIDET` folder and right-click `installera.bat` → **Run as administrator**.
3. If Windows says "Windows protected your PC": **More info** → **Run anyway**.

VST3 (in C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3) and a standalone .exe. 64-bit Windows 10 or 11.

LINUX

1. Unzip `SMIDET-Linux.zip`.
2. Run `bash ~/Downloads/SMIDET/installera-linux.sh`. It copies the plug-ins to `~/.vst3` and `~/.lv2`.
3. Rescan plug-ins in your DAW (Bitwig, Reaper, Ardour and others).

VST3 and LV2, 64-bit x86 Linux (built on Ubuntu 22.04).

> SWEDISH OR ENGLISH
> The machines have Swedish names on the panel. One click on `SV | EN` in the header switches labels, menus and tooltips to English. Your choice is remembered for every MASKINHALLEN machine.

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03 UNLOCK WITH YOUR KEY

Your purchase comes with a licence key: four groups of four characters, like `XXXX-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX`. You find it in the Payhip email and on your receipt.

1. Open SMIDET. Until it is unlocked, the window shows **UNLOCK SMIDET**.
2. Paste the whole key in the field and press `UNLOCK`.
3. Done. You only need to do this once per computer: every MASKINHALLEN machine on the computer finds the key. A bundle key unlocks every machine.

The key is not case sensitive, and I/L and O/0 are treated as the same character, so a typo there does not matter. If it says the key does not work, check that the whole key was pasted. You can use your key on your own computers.

THE FREE DEMO

Every machine has a free demo with the same sound engine. Some presets and functions are locked, and the demo has its own name (SMIDET DEMO), so it can sit next to the full version. Buying the full version is what unlocks everything; install it and paste your key.

UPDATES

Updates are free for life. Download the new zip from your Payhip receipt link and run the installer again. Your projects and your key are kept.

04 YOUR FIRST MINUTE

1. Put SMIDET on an instrument track and press play in your DAW. SMIDET follows the tempo and position.
2. Pick a preset at the top. Start in **TRUMSMEDJAN** (drum forge), **BAS** or **ACID**.
3. Press `ALLT` (ALL) for a completely new forge, or `NY SLINGA` (NEW LOOP) for new note loops with the same rhythm and sounds.
4. Click a ring to select a smith. Drag around the ring to rotate its pattern, scroll to add or remove hits.
5. Turn `GLÖD` (GLOW) and `HAMMARE` (HAMMER) in the hearth and listen to the forge heat up.

05 THE RINGS

- Each smith is a ring. Ring 1 (outermost) is the bass.
- Glowing dots are hits. Hollow hits are skipped, by CHAOS or because another smith in the same team got there first.
- **Click** a ring to select the smith. **Drag around** to rotate the pattern, **scroll** for more or fewer hits.
- The centre shows the key and how many bars are left until ETTAN.

06 A SMITH

Each of the four smith rows has the same controls.

`MATERIAL`	What is struck: the sound engine (next chapter).
`HAMMARE`	Hammer: **HÅRD** (hard), **MJUK** (soft), **GNISTA** (spark), **BÄLG** (bellows). On metal it is how the anvil is hit; on the synth engines it chooses one of four variants.
`STEG · SLAG · VRID`	The euclidean rhythm: steps, hits and rotation.
`TONER`	Length of the note loop. With 5 notes against 7 hits they drift apart and meet again: note euclid.
`OMFÅNG · OKTAV`	How many scale steps the loop uses, and octave.
`KLANG · LJUS`	How long and how bright it rings.
`STUDS`	The hammer bounces on the anvil, faster and softer.
`KEDJA`	Chain: the hit bounces on to the next smith.

GLID	Notes glide into each other.
TAKT	Rate: 1/8, 1/16, 1/16 triplets or 1/32.
LAG	Team: ALONE, TEAM A or TEAM B. Smiths in the same team take turns, like two smiths at one anvil.
DRIV · FILTER · PUNCH	Character per smith (SMIDET 4): drive, a low/high-pass filter, and punch on the attack.

The dice on each row randomises that smith.

07 THE 26 MATERIALS

Materials are grouped by what they do. The hammer picks the variant in brackets.

METAL (MODAL SYNTHESIS)

STÅL	Steel: a clear bell, long ring, glittering top.
GJUTJÄRN	Cast iron: dark and heavy, an anvil that clonks.
PLÅT	Sheet metal: rattling, dense, untuned, almost a gong.
RÖR	Tuned pipe: clean fundamental, good for bass.
KEDJA	A steel string that plucks.
ACKORD	A whole chord in the anvil, so every hit becomes a dub stab.

DRUM FORGE

KICK	Synthesised kick that follows the loop (punch, deep boom, industrial, rumble). LJUS = click, ROST = drive.
HAT	Six metal oscillators (closed, soft, ride, open). KLANG = length.
CLAP	Noise bursts (clap, snare, rim, industrial snare).
PLONK	A low-pass gate, minimal techno's plonk (wood, bongo, metal, drop). LJUS opens.
BRUS	Noise that follows the note: tight hat, shaker, sharp hat, steam.

SYNTH ENGINES

SUB	Sine bass with a pitch drop on hard hits. ROST saturates.

SYRA	Acid: saw (square with MJUK) through a resonant four-pole filter with envelope and accent. Glide works.
FM · FM4	Two- and four-operator FM: bells, e-piano, blips, metal and soft surfaces.
STAB · DUB	Chords of saws through a closing filter, and chord stabs with their own echo.
STRÄNG	Plucked string (steel, dub pluck, metal, bowed).
FAS	Phase distortion like an old 80s synth (saw, pulse, resonance, sweep).
RAVE	Seven detuned saws: supersaw stab, soft pad, hoover, reese bass.
FORMANT	Vowels: ah-oh, soft oo, fast vocal chop, choir.
KORN	A granular cloud of the smith's note: glitch, cloud, sparks, frozen drone.

SAMPLES

PROVBAS · PROVSTAB · PROVYTA	Built-in sampled basses, stabs and surfaces, tuned to the note loop.
EGET	Your own sound (next chapter).

08 YOUR OWN SOUNDS: FOLDERS AND LIBRARIES

Set a smith's material to EGET (OWN) and it plays your samples.

- The LJUD (SOUND) button on the smith's row opens a menu of your folders. Subfolders are included, one menu per folder.
- **Add folder** takes a single folder or a whole sample library. **Remove folder** takes it out of the list.
- Pick a file, or **randomise from the same folder** to audition sounds in time.
- Drag a file onto the row to use it, or drag a folder there to add it.
- STÄMD (TUNED) tunes the sound to the note loop (SMIDET guesses the root note). SOM DEN ÄR (AS IS) plays it untouched, for drums.

Your folder list is kept for every project. The sound you chose is saved in the project.

09 THE FORGE AND THE HEARTH

THE FORGE

Scale · key	Minor, Phrygian, Dorian, minor pentatonic, harmonic minor, fifths, octaves, major, chromatic. Notes can never land wrong.
Chord	The chord in the ACKORD anvil and the stab engines.
ETTAN	Every 1, 2, 4 or 8 bars all rings and loops reset. However skewed it gets, it lands on the one.
DÉJÀ VU	Locks the note loops. At 100 % the same melody plays every period; lower values swap notes here and there so the loop mutates slowly.
KAOS	Hits drop out, notes jump an octave, velocities live. The first hit of each ring never drops.
SYMPATI	The other anvils ring faintly along, like sitar strings.
GNISTOR	Hard hits spray metal sparks in stereo.
HÄRDNING	Quench: the metal is dipped in water after every hit, choking the ring.
ROST	Rust: a little out of tune, duller and shorter.
SUB	A clean sub bass that follows smith 1.

THE HEARTH

HAMMARE	Denser and harder: more hits, harder hammers, more sparks. In the middle the rings are as they are.
GLÖD	Glow: longer and brighter ring, and the forge saturates.
EKO	A dub echo that bounces left and right and darkens on every repeat.
RUM	The room of the forge.
BUSS	One knob for a compressor, tape and limiter on everything.

10 TOP BAR, KEYS AND MIDI

ALLT	A completely new forge.
NY SLINGA	New note loops, same rhythms and sounds.
HÄRDA	Harden: freezes the note loops as they sound now, without DÉJÀ VU swaps and chaos.

`DRA MIDI`	Drag the rings' patterns (4 bars, one track per smith) into your DAW and play them with any synth.

KEYS AND GESTURES

Middle C (60) is called C3, as in Bitwig and Ableton.

NOTE	WHAT HAPPENS
C0	**SLÄCK**: only the one in every bar is struck
C#0	**STORM**: all rings twice as fast
D0	**ÄSSJAN**: glow fully up while held
D#0	**HÄRDNING**: everything ringing is quenched
C2 and up	The keyboard

The keyboard has three modes: **TRANSPOSE** (default: the lowest key becomes the new root, several keys become the chord), **PLAY** (keys play a chosen smith directly, even with the transport stopped) and **OFF**.

11 PRESETS

302 presets in 22 categories. The handmade ones: DUBSTABS, BASGÅNGAR, KLOCKOR, INDUSTRI, HYPNOS, KAOS, SYNTSMEDJA, MÖRK TECHNO, PROV, TRUMSMEDJAN, TONSMEDJAN and RAVEHALLEN. And 220 more in KICK, HAT, PERC, PLONK, STAB, DUB, BAS, ACID, RAVE and TUNG INDUSTRI.

Old projects keep their sounds: new materials were added last, so nothing shifts.

12 TROUBLESHOOTING

SMIDET does not show up	Quit the DAW completely and start it again, or rescan plug-ins. On Mac, run the installer again: it removes macOS's quarantine on the plug-in. On Windows, check that `SMIDET.vst3` is in C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3.
macOS says the plug-in is damaged	That is macOS's block on downloaded files. Run `bash ~/Downloads/SMIDET/installera.command` again.
Windows protected your PC	Click **More info** → **Run anyway**. The plug-ins are not signed with a paid certificate.

The key does not work	Paste the whole key, including the dashes. A key for one machine only unlocks that machine; a bundle key unlocks all.
No sound	Press play in the DAW: the machines follow the transport. Instruments go on an instrument track, effects on an audio track or bus.

Anything else? Ask through the store, and the person who built the machine answers.

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